Eval AI on AWS

Cost estimate · Mumbai region (ap-south-1) · prices checked 30 October 2026

Summary

Option	Setup	US$ / month	₹ / month incl. 18% GST	₹ / year incl. GST
A	Always on, g4dn.xlarge	$472.29	₹49,043	₹588,516
B	Always on, g6.xlarge	$755.10	₹78,409	₹940,910
C	Split: small app server + GPU in school hours	$211.53	₹21,965	₹263,586
D	Option A with a 1-year Savings Plan	$315.91	₹32,804	₹393,644

Recommendation: start with **Option A** (about **$472.29** a month, **₹49,043** with GST). After two or three months of steady use, buy a 1-year Savings Plan (Option D, about $315.91). If the budget is tight and grading only happens in school hours, Option C is about $211.53 but needs extra setup.

Assumptions: 730 hours in a month; US$1 = ₹88 (check the day's rate); 18% GST applies when AWS India (AISPL) bills you. Prices are on-demand list prices in Mumbai unless stated.

Where the money goes

In Option A the GPU server is **89%** of the bill. Everything else (database, disk, backups, IP address, DNS) adds up to about **$49.62** a month. Saving money means reducing GPU hours or committing to a GPU for a year.

Option A: Always on, g4dn.xlarge

Recommended start. Matches the deployment guide.

Item	Quantity × unit price	US$ / month
EC2 g4dn.xlarge (T4 16 GB), always on	730 h × $0.579	$422.67
EBS gp3 disk	120 GB × $0.0912	$10.94
RDS PostgreSQL db.t4g.small, Single-AZ	730 h × $0.042	$30.66
RDS gp3 storage	20 GB × $0.131	$2.62
S3 backups (Standard)	50 GB × $0.025	$1.25
Public IPv4 address (Elastic IP)	730 h × $0.005	$3.65
Route 53 hosted zone (if DNS is on AWS)	1 zone	$0.50
Data transfer out	under 100 GB/month free	$0.00
Total (before GST)		**$472.29**

Option B: Always on, g6.xlarge

24 GB of GPU memory instead of 16 GB: room to raise parallel jobs.

Item	Quantity × unit price	US$ / month
EC2 g6.xlarge (L4 24 GB), always on	730 h × $0.9664	$705.47
EBS gp3 disk	120 GB × $0.0912	$10.94
RDS PostgreSQL db.t4g.small, Single-AZ	730 h × $0.042	$30.66
RDS gp3 storage	20 GB × $0.131	$2.62
S3 backups (Standard)	50 GB × $0.025	$1.25
Public IPv4 address (Elastic IP)	730 h × $0.005	$3.65
Route 53 hosted zone (if DNS is on AWS)	1 zone	$0.50
Data transfer out	under 100 GB/month free	$0.00
Total (before GST)		**$755.10**

Option C: Split: small app server + GPU in school hours

Cheapest. Needs a second server and a start/stop schedule (extra setup).

Item	Quantity × unit price	US$ / month
EC2 t3.medium app server, always on	730 h × $0.0448	$32.70
EBS gp3 disk (app server)	40 GB × $0.0912	$3.65
EC2 g4dn.xlarge GPU, school hours only	220 h × $0.579	$127.38
EBS gp3 disk (GPU server, billed when stopped)	100 GB × $0.0912	$9.12
RDS PostgreSQL db.t4g.small, Single-AZ	730 h × $0.042	$30.66
RDS gp3 storage	20 GB × $0.131	$2.62
S3 backups (Standard)	50 GB × $0.025	$1.25
Public IPv4 address (Elastic IP)	730 h × $0.005	$3.65
Route 53 hosted zone (if DNS is on AWS)	1 zone	$0.50
Data transfer out	under 100 GB/month free	$0.00
Total (before GST)		**$211.53**

Option D: Option A with a 1-year Savings Plan

After 2-3 months, once you know the server stays.

Item	Quantity × unit price	US$ / month
EC2 g4dn.xlarge, 1-year Savings Plan (est.)	730 h × ~$0.365	$266.28
EBS gp3 disk	120 GB × $0.0912	$10.94
RDS PostgreSQL db.t4g.small, Single-AZ	730 h × $0.042	$30.66
RDS gp3 storage	20 GB × $0.131	$2.62
S3 backups (Standard)	50 GB × $0.025	$1.25
Public IPv4 address (Elastic IP)	730 h × $0.005	$3.65
Route 53 hosted zone (if DNS is on AWS)	1 zone	$0.50
Data transfer out	under 100 GB/month free	$0.00
Total (before GST)		**$315.91**

Unit prices used

Service	Mumbai price	Source
EC2 g4dn.xlarge (Linux, on-demand)	$0.579 / hour	aws-pricing.com regional table
EC2 g6.xlarge (Linux, on-demand)	$0.9664 / hour	aws-pricing.com, DoiT (both agree)
EC2 g5.xlarge (for comparison)	$1.208 / hour	aws-pricing.com
EC2 t3.medium	$0.0448 / hour	aws-pricing.com
EBS gp3 storage	$0.0912 / GB-month	aws-pricing.com (3,000 IOPS and 125 MB/s included)
RDS PostgreSQL db.t4g.small, Single-AZ	$0.042 / hour	AWS Price List API (official), Oct 2026
RDS PostgreSQL db.t4g.micro / medium	$0.021 / $0.084 per hour	AWS Price List API (official)
RDS gp3 storage, Single-AZ	$0.131 / GB-month	AWS Price List API (official)
S3 Standard storage	~$0.025 / GB-month	Third-party summaries
Public IPv4 address	$0.005 / hour	AWS (same in all regions)
Data transfer out to internet	First 100 GB/month free, then ~$0.109/GB	AWS free allowance; third-party rate
Route 53 hosted zone	$0.50 / month	AWS (global)

The official AWS price list was read directly for RDS. EC2, S3 and transfer prices come from third-party price trackers. Before you commit, check them in the AWS Pricing Calculator (calculator.aws) with region Asia Pacific (Mumbai) selected.

Costs that are free or outside AWS

Item	Cost
HTTPS certificate (Let's Encrypt)	Free
RDS automated backups up to the database size	Free
Data transfer in (uploads of papers and answer sheets)	Free

Item	Cost
CloudWatch basic metrics, SSM Parameter Store (standard)	Free
Ollama, InternVL3.5 4B, IndicOCR model	No licence fee (accept the IndicOCR licence on Hugging Face)
Domain name (.in), bought outside AWS	About ₹700-1,200 a year
Google Play developer account (only if publishing on Play)	US$25 once
Expo EAS builds	Free tier is enough for occasional release builds

Ways to bring the bill down

- **Stop the GPU when nobody grades.** Every hour stopped saves $0.579 on g4dn.xlarge. Disks and the IP address are still billed while stopped. With one server (Option A) stopping also takes the website offline, which is why Option C splits the app from the GPU.
- **Savings Plan.** A 1-year EC2 Instance Savings Plan cuts the GPU price by roughly 35-40% (Option D). It is a commitment to pay for the hours whether you use them or not.
- **Spot instances** are 40-50% cheaper but AWS can take them back with two minutes' notice. Not suitable for the main server; possible later for an extra GPU during exam season.
- **Right-size the database.** db.t4g.micro ($0.021/hour, about $15 a month) is enough for a single school at the start; move up to db.t4g.small when needed.

Paying for exam season only (GPU hours)

GPU hours in the month	g4dn.xlarge	g6.xlarge
50 h	$28.95	$48.32
100 h	$57.90	$96.64
220 h	$127.38	$212.61
400 h	$231.60	$386.56
730 h (always on)	$422.67	$705.47

GPU cost only, before GST. Add the fixed costs of the chosen option (database, disks, IP, backups).